

Police and Fire Holiday Meals Process

Purpose and background:

The PVE NW has a longtime tradition of providing holiday meals to PVE PD and Fire Dept staff who work on Thanksgiving and Christmas days. This is the PVE Neighborhood Watch gift to our first responders as a thank you from the community for their service.

The vice president coordinates this process with the PVE NW board, PVE PD community relations officer (EPCOC), meal vendors and PVE NW Treasurer. The entire process may take a collective 4 - 6 hours for each holiday.

Individual meals are ordered from a vendor. In the past, we have tried to use local PVE vendors, such as our markets. The vendor needs to be able to support the holiday pick-up day/time. The individual meals allow for each emergency responder to have their portion at their respective mealtime.

Timeline (Thanksgiving meals):

- **October board meeting:**
 - Approve the holiday meals budget for Thanksgiving and Christmas. This is usually a rough number based on the prior year's expenses, and adding a buffer for estimated increased costs. The vendors usually do not have their menus at this time.
- **Early November:**
 - Coordinate with the EPCOC to get the count of Police and Fire that will be working on Thanksgiving. (See appendix A – sample communication with EPCOC.
 - Coordinate with meal providers, getting cost, menu and pick-up option/times. In the past, we have tried to use our local businesses to support them. They have been very generous and the food has been very good. (See Appendix B – coordinating tips with vendors and contact names).
 - Coordinate food pick-up and storage, if needed (see Appendix B). Typically, the PD pick up their meal and the Fire Department will pick

up their meal. Each must be able to store their meals at their locations.

- Work with EPCOC on flyer advising both PD and FD on event and or selections. A sample flyer is included below (Appendix D). Remember that this is a gift from the PVE Neighborhood Watch members.
- **Week before Thanksgiving:**
 - Confirm count and pick-up times/dates with vendor (see Appendix C for sample email to vendor)
 - Provide total amount to PVE NW treasure for check (vendors are trusting, so you may pay after delivery. Work out a plan with the vendor so everyone is clear.
 - Obtain a receipt/invoice for the PVE NW Treasure.
- **Within a week after Thanksgiving:**
 - Get feedback from EPCOC on process and meals quality/taste.
 - Provide thank you note to vendor (we have PVE NW stationary, and handwritten is nice because they may want to post it on the staff to appreciate.)

Timeline (Christmas meals):

- **Early December:**
 - Coordinate with EPCOC to get the count of Police and Fire that will be working on Thanksgiving. (See Appendix A – sample communication with EPCOC).
 - Coordinate with meal provider, getting cost, menu and pick-up option/times. In the past, we have tried to use our local businesses to support them. They have been very generous and the food has been good. (See Appendix B – coordinating tip with vendors, See Appendix D for vendors and contact names).
 - Coordinate food pick-up and storage, if needed (see Appendix B). Typically, the PD pick up their meal and the Fire Department will pick up their meal each must be able to store their meals at their locations.
 - Work with EPCOC on flyer advising both PD and FD on event and/or selections. A sample flyer is included below (Appendix E). Remember that this is a gift from the PVE Neighborhood Watch members.

- **Week before Christmas:**
 - Confirm count and pick-up time/days with vendor (see Appendix C for simple email to vendor.)
 - Provide total amount of PVE NW treasure for check. (Vendors are trusting, so you may pay after delivery. Work out a plan with the vendor, so everyone is clear).
 - Obtain a receipt/invoice for the PVE NW Treasure
- **Early January:**
 - Get feedback from EPCOC on process and meal quality/taste.
 - Provide thank you note to vendor (we have PVE NW stationary and handwritten is nice because they may want to post it for the staff to appreciate).

The instructions for PVE NW vice president:

- **Make sure approval and conversation of holiday meals get on the October board meeting.**
 - Verify the process, potential vendors being used with the board
 - Obtain budget approval for both Thanksgiving and Christmas meal
 - Determine which vendors to use (See Appendix B). There may be new ideas or a change desired.
 - Provide cost and feedback from last year
 - Get a rough count from EPCOC
 - EPCOC may be able to provide some insight or feedback from last year, too.
- **Contact vendors:**
 - When you call vendors, have the rough count of meals for both PD and FD.
 - Verified that they can provide the holiday meal with the pick-up time needed (see Appendix B for details)
 - How late are they open on the actual holiday?
 - What is their quote? (Note: they may want to donate the entire cost, but we do not let them do that because this is our/the community's gift to PD and FD.
 - What is the menu: are there any choices that need to be indicated (some benders have options)

- **Coordinate with EPCOC:**

- Get final count, separated by PD & FD.
- Coordinate pick up times separated by PD (2 shifts) and FD. It's good to know who might be picking things up in case there is an issue
- Coordinate/confirm any other details. The EPCOC has been a great team member to be our direct liaison with the PD and FD.
- Can they take a photo with the vendor picking up their meal for our newsletter/website?

- **Confirm on day before pick up**

- Confirmation is always helpful to ensure there were no misunderstandings and everything is going as expected.
- Confirm with EPCOC
- Confirm with vendor and have them send receipt or have a receipt for pick-up so the order can be paid for.
- Provide payment amount and instructions to PVE NW Treasure. In the past, vendors have accepted a check and may not need it on the day. However, we like to pay the bill as soon as possible and sometimes before pick-up.

THANKSGIVING THURSDAY, NOVEMBER 28TH			CHRISTMAS DINNER DECEMBER 25TH		
			AM SHIFT	Venegas	
PD AM SHIFT				Flores	
	Crisfield			Zabukovec	
	Zabukovec			Bre Hernandez	
	Banuelos				
	Nahra				
	Dispatch: Jenny				
			FD	FD 1	
FD	FD 1			FD 2	
	FD 2			FD 3	
	FD 3			FD 4	
	FD 4			FD 5	
	FD 5				
PD PM SHIFT			PM SHIFT		
	Alvarez			Ackert	
	Flores			Zavala	
	Zavala			IX	
	Dispatch: Hazel			Bre Malave	

Appendix A – Sample email communication with EPCOC

Use this template as the format for accounts, pick-ups and other key information that the vendor needs. Make sure the president is on copy for all emails.

Hello, XXXXXX (EPCOC),

Here is the holiday meal information from last year to use as a template to update the accounts for this year.

Meal order for Thanksgiving 2025

- 11 meals for PVE PD (see details below) to be paid for by PVE Neighborhood Watch
- 5 meals for Fire Department (see details below) to be paid for by PVE Neighborhood Watch

Meal order for Christmas Eve/Christmas 2025:

- We have a few new officers that we wanted to ensure that they were aware of the outpouring of support our community gifts, so that is why we have meals for Christmas Eve. **(Note, we usually only do Christmas Day, but this is an example of an exception).**
- The Fire Department gets meals only for Christmas Day, 12/25

Appendix B - Meal Vendor Tips

1. In the past few years, we have worked with the city's local markets. They have been generous partners. It has been nice to share the business with them. They usually have a holiday meal menu, so we just tap into what they are offering to the public.
 - a. Malaga Cove Ranch Market:
Contact: Nuna (F) and Nersus.
310.375.2683
43. Malaga Cove Plaza
You may need to coordinate individual meals with them, since their menu to the public is typically "family style"
 - b. Lunada Market & Deli:
Contact: Rick or Jocelyn (spoken: Josslean) Lopez.
424.206.2880
2201 Palos Verdes Drive West
They typically have individual meals as part of their holiday offerings.
2. Make sure you know the open days and times for all vendors for Thanksgiving and Christmas, so that you can determine which vendor will work best for each event.
3. Meals are picked up by Fire and Police for their respective teams and shifts
4. The vendor needs to be open on the day of the event or the meals will need to be picked up and stored the day before.
5. If meal storage is needed, the Fire and Police will need to store on their sites. If there is a problem, something will need to be coordinated with the EPCOC or a resident.
6. Vendor will bag the meals so that there is one group for Fire and one group for each of the PD shifts. Each meal is one grocery bag. So, 11 meals are 11 grocery bags.
7. Meals will need to be microwaved. Lunada Market includes instructions. Meals include containers and plasti-wear and napkins. Menu typically consists of traditional holiday meat, side, dishes, and dessert. New beverages are included. No need for PVE NW to provide beverages.

Appendix C – Email to Meal Vendor to let them know our Order and our Process

Hello (Meal Vendor Contact),

Meals Order:

Disorder will be a total of 16 meals. Please provide a total amount and invoice/receipt so we can provide payment.

- 11 meals for PVE PD
- 5 meals for Fire Department

Pick up plan:

I understand that the market will be open on 11/24 from 8 AM - 2 PM.

- PVE PD will pick up their 11 meals on 11/24 between 12 - 1 PM
 - It would be helpful if you can group/identify the meals by date and shift as noted in the meal details, below. Thank you.
- Fire Dept will pick up their five meals on 11/24 between 12 – 1 PM

Appendix D – Sample Flyer from EPCOC to Fire & Police

PVE NW will provide, on behalf of the EPCOC, to lighten their workload and provide the information they need for the PD and FD directly.



The PVE Neighborhood Watch Board and the Community of Palos Verdes Estates thank you first responders for your service on Thanksgiving Day and throughout the year



**Please enjoy this Classic Thanksgiving Dinner
made by the
Malaga Cove Ranch Market**

- Oven Roasted Turkey Breast with Gravy
 - Mashed Potatoes
 - Corn, Carrot, Onion Stuffing
 - Roasted Asparagus
 - Cranberry Sauce
 - Fall Dessert
- Meals to be picked up at Malaga Cove Ranch Market on **Thursday, 11/28 between 12noon and 3pm (they close at 3:30 pm)**
 - Fire Department to pick up their meals, PVE PD to pick up their meals for both shifts.
 - Note, you will need to have room in your refrigerators for the meals.

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Appendix E – Sample Christmas Flyer from EPCOC to Fire & Police

PVE NW will provide, on behalf of the EPCOC, to lighten their workload and provide the information they need for the PD and FD directly.



The PVE Neighborhood Watch Board and
Community of Palos Verdes Estates thank you
first responders for your service on
Christmas Day and throughout the year

**Please enjoy this Classic Christmas Dinner made by the
Lunada Market & Deli**

- Butternut Squash Soup
 - Market Salad with Balsamic Vinaigrette
 - Slow Roasted Beef Brisket with Bordelaise
 - Creamy Mashed Potatoes
 - Brown Sugar Carrots with Orange Zest
 - Ooey-Gooey Chocolate Fudge Bar with Cream & Berries
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- Meals to be picked up at Lunada Market & Deli on Tuesday, 12/24 between 12noon and 2:30pm (they close at 3:00 pm)
 - Fire Department to pick up their meals, PVE PD to pick up their meals for both shifts.
 - Each meal will be personalized AND ARE FOR THE WORKERS ON CHRISTMAS DAY
 - Note, you will need to have room in your refrigerators for the meals.

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